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Why Josh Kushner's Thrive is expanding beyond venture

By [Rosie Bradbury](#)

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Joshua Kushner's [Thrive Capital](#) made its first big splash in venture with its lucrative bet on Instagram, and has since become the face of [OpenAI](#)'s mammoth fundraising rounds, making multiple investments in the AI leader since 2023.

But with its surprising investment in NYSE-listed car marketplace [Carvana](#)—which yielded a \$522 million return on a three-year investment, Bloomberg reported Wednesday—Thrive is one of a growing number of firms to expand beyond its venture roots as the industry appears to bifurcate.

Thrive's continued expansion into a multistrategy player makes sense: Last year, the firm raised \$5 billion in fresh powder.

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"As you scale in size, it becomes harder to focus solely on early-stage opportunities," said Renee Hanna, managing director of [Baylor University's endowment](#), which is not an investor in Thrive.

Stock-picking isn't Thrive's only foray outside of venture—a few weeks ago, Kushner announced its own version of a PE roll-up play. Thrive Holdings, a new permanent capital vehicle, will integrate AI into legacy industries by creating new companies and buying up existing ones. ([General Catalyst](#) rolled out a similar strategy last year.)

While the first investors in Thrive's permanent capital vehicle include existing backers, not all LPs may be comfortable with the multistrategy approach. For one, it can create an entirely different return profile than a typical VC fund.

This article originally appeared in the Capital Pool newsletter. [Subscribe to the newsletter here](#)

Venture firms can, and often do, hold onto shares of their portfolio companies after an IPO. But buying public stocks with the sole objective of selling them higher is not in the typical venture fund's remit. (Thrive did not invest in Carvana before its IPO.)

Thrive also will have seen significant upside from selling its public position in [Robinhood](#) late last year, according to quarterly records of its public stock holdings disclosed in 13F-HR SEC filings.

Thrive Capital declined to comment on this article.

While the Kushners and Andreessens of the world [can raise effectively unlimited supplies of capital](#), there’s still a second cohort of firms that are still coveted but are sticking with boutique vehicles: [Union Square Ventures](#) and [Benchmark](#) haven’t strayed from venture’s original roots, for example.

And these old school-style firms are having to reassure their LPs that no, they don’t have a long-term capital strategy waiting in the wings.

“A number of large venture funds that I went to annual meetings with recently really reinforced the fact that they are disciplined in a venture approach,” said John Clendenin, chair of [Cooley](#)’s fund formation practice.

“I think they’re trying to shore up investor inquiry about whether they would also be enticed to go and pursue this.”

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About [Rosie Bradbury](#)

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter covering startups and venture capital for PitchBook News. Based in New York, she previously reported for the Bureau of Investigative Journalism, Business Insider and Wired. Rosie studied history and politics at the University of Cambridge.

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